

DIGITAL NOTETAKING HACKS

Study more efficiently with these tips

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In an age of constant digital distractions, staying focused on studying can be tough. But with the right tools, students can turn chaos into clarity. We'll explore three powerful tool combos—Google Lens, Notion, and Drive; WhatsApp chat with yourself; and Canva for visual learning—that turn scattered notes into a streamlined, personalized study system.

1. The Google Lens-Notion-Drive Note-Taking Ecosystem

For digital students, combining Google Lens, Drive, and Notion creates an efficient, flexible study workflow.

Google Lens: The Smart Scanner in Your Pocket

Instead of writing or typing complex textbook diagrams or definitions, just point your camera at the page and scan with Google Lens. It converts text—including clear handwriting—into digital notes, which you can save to Notion or Drive. It works especially well for:

- Capturing definitions, formulas, or data tables from textbooks..
- Translating foreign language material in language studies.

Google Drive: The Digital Archive

Upload and organize your scans and notes in Drive.

Its powerful search and syncing make it easy to find materials by subject or exam module. Drive syncs across devices and supports collaboration, plus you can link files directly inside Notion for seamless access.

Notion: The Command Center

Notion brings structure and function to your note-taking. It's more than a notes app; it's a second brain. You can create linked databases for:

- Lecture notes sorted by date and subject
- Assignment trackers with deadlines and status



A database might include a "Biology Notes" section, with pages linking to diagrams in Drive, scans from Google Lens, and your summaries.

You can tag pages with topics like "Cell Division" or "Genetics" and use filters to prep for exams.

Students using this full-stack system spend less time searching and more time studying, streamlining their workflow to match their pace.

2. WhatsApp: The Brain Dump

You might not see WhatsApp as a study tool, but it's great for quickly capturing ideas and revisiting them later—just start a chat with yourself.